THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Child's Story** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** life seems to speed up as we age	It is the author's comment on the pace of life.
2	**(c)** would always be close	A lifelong friendship.
3	**(b)** calm acceptance after grief	The old man is serene.
4	**(b)** the future is unknown at the beginning of life	The darkness hints at the unknown.
5	**(a)** directly addressing his listeners	He speaks to the audience.
6	**(a)** the closing years of life	Sunset is a common symbol of old age.
7	**(c)** even weather is a source of joy	Child's joy extends to every season.
8	**(d)** to mock the reader's family	The humour is affectionate, not mocking.
9	**(d)** the end of companionship through death	Even the last friend must leave.
10	**(c)** The wind came whistling and howling.	Whistling and howling imitate sounds.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To show a child's delight in everything around him (1). It also builds a warm picture of carefree days (1).	1+1
12	To make the listener smile (1). It brings the story close to the family and adds humour (1).	1+1
13	It shows time passing (1). It prepares for his old age and loss (1).	1+1
14	It shows a child's wonder (1). To children, fairy tales feel fresh and real (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Play defines childhood (1). It shows innocence and joy (1). It sets up the pattern of invitations in each stage (1).	1+1+1
16	Humans fear separation (1). He hopes for more time with his wife (1). It makes the reader feel his sorrow (1).	1+1+1
17	The child said that he was always at play (1). Present tense becomes past (1). 'I' becomes 'he' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Each person defines himself by one activity (1). The pattern shows the stage of life (1). It helps the reader remember and compare the stages (1).	1+1+1
18	It is the voice of the child who went to Heaven (1). It calls the mother as well (1). It marks the loss that comes with age (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The principal praised the school's principle of honesty (1). The council sought the counsel of an expert (1). Each word is used in its correct sense (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Spoken by the narrator at the end (1). Addressed to Grandfather (1). The traveller's life stands for the Grandfather's (1). It shows the exchange of love between young and old (1). It turns the tale into a tribute (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format and greeting (1). Thanks for the story (1). Memories of your own stages (1). Advice to enjoy each stage (1). Loving close (1).	2+2+1
20	Child's play (1). Boy's learning (1). Young man's love (1). Adult's work and family (1). Old man's memory, each with its own joy (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The child lives in the present (1). The old man lives in the past (1). Both are happy and calm (1). Both welcome the traveller (1). Together they frame the story (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Child's Story** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a pattern of passing time	Each stage is left behind.
2	**(a)** a life that has reached its rest	A fallen tree is a place of rest.
3	**(a)** rumbling	It imitates a deep sound.
4	**(b)** the journey is shared with a family	Family life begins.
5	**(d)** faces the end of life without fear	He is calm.
6	**(d)** silence and calm	Hush means quiet.
7	**(b)** paths that open for children to follow their own lives	Each avenue is a different life path.
8	**(b)** The traveller finds his friends in memory and loves them all	His lost friends return in memory.
9	**(a)** snowflakes like down from white birds	'Like down' compares flakes with feathers.
10	**(b)** a child died young	Heaven means death.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The path becomes a wood (1). It becomes harder, needing labour and care (1).	1+1
12	A child 'rose into the golden air' (1). The mother is 'drawn' softly into shade (1).	1+1
13	The traveller forgot much of the learning (1). The remark is humorous and shows learning stays only partly (1).	1+1
14	Adult life needs hard work (1). It means taking care of family and others (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The start has a dark path (1). The end has a sunset (1). Together they frame life's journey from the unknown to a calm end (1).	1+1+1
16	Spring: childhood and youth (1). Summer: busy family life (1). Autumn: ageing and loss (1).	1+1+1
17	She gave him a compliment on his speech (1). A scarf can complement a coat (1). The two words differ in meaning: praise and completion (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Humour through Fanny and 'Somebody' (1). Emotion in love and engagement (1). The mix makes the story warm and sincere (1).	1+1+1
18	Nothing in life stays the same (1). Each stage must pass (1). Accepting change brings calm (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Stationary means not moving: the car was stationary (1). Stationery means writing materials: she bought stationery (1). Spelling and meaning differ (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	The wood is life (1). Seasonal change shows ageing (1). Avenues show children's different paths (1). The sunset shows the end (1). Together they give a complete picture (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Traveller meets child and boy (1). Then young man in love (1). Then gentleman, wife and children and their partings (1). Then the old man at sunset (1). Friends return in memory (1).	2+2+1
20	Gentle language: 'summoned' and 'drawn' (1). The father's plea (1). Her tender kiss (1). Her quiet departure (1). The traveller's silence afterwards (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Simple characters stand for ideas (1). Repeated pattern builds the theme (1). Poetic images suit the subject (1). A personal ending adds warmth (1). A short story can carry a deep message (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 11: **The Child's Story** | Class 8 English_Ruskin_Bond | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** memories keep loved ones alive	Memory preserves what we love.
2	**(b)** stories feel real	A child believes the tales.
3	**(a)** fears losing his wife	He pleads for more time.
4	**(d)** it shows the tale is a tribute to an elder	It turns a fable into a personal tribute.
5	**(a)** boy - learning; young man - love	The pairs follow the text.
6	**(d)** to show death as a gentle pull	The imagery is soft and sad.
7	**(a)** a child tells it to a loved elder	The narrator is a child speaking to Grandfather.
8	**(a)** light-hearted	A humorous understatement.
9	**(b)** love even as she leaves	A tender detail.
10	**(a)** affectionate, gentle and reflective	The tone is warm and gentle.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To show he has peace in old age (1). He has accepted life's changes (1).	1+1
12	It shows boyhood is also full of joy (1). Learning and sport go together (1).	1+1
13	The children leave with 'many tears' (1). The parents look at the sky and feel time pass (1).	1+1
14	The narrator speaks directly to Grandfather (1). It turns from fable to tribute and is more personal (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Each person stands for one stage (1). It keeps the story simple like a fable (1). It makes the stages easy to compare (1).	1+1+1
16	Memory is the work of old age (1). He invites the traveller to relive the past (1). Remembering brings back all lost friends (1).	1+1+1
17	He addresses 'dear Grandfather' (1). He says 'what we do to you' (1). He uses a playful, affectionate tone (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It shows a child hurrying to join the family (1). It gives a picture of a growing family (1). It prepares the later partings (1).	1+1+1
18	At the start he follows each companion eagerly (1). At the end he sits calmly with memories (1). He becomes kind and forbearing (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It has symbolic characters (1). Each person stands for a stage of life (1). It gives a moral rather than action (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	All lost friends return when the old man remembers (1). He had lost nothing (1). He becomes kind and forbearing (1). Memory brings peace (1). It makes old age rich (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Child's play vs the old man's quiet (1). Love's joy vs the parting of children (1). Spring vs autumn (1). Youth vs grey hair (1). The contrast shows life's full range (1).	2+2+1
20	Catchy title (1). Opening linking to the story (1). Elders' wisdom and love (1). How we can care for them (1). Strong closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting and opening (1). Name the story and writer (1). Reasons: theme and images (1). Personal link to a family elder (1). Closing message (1).	2+2+1

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